

As part of the National Academy of Sports Medicine's support services, we are pleased to provide you with a 15-week study plan to help you stay on track. Data from other NASM members like you show that learners perform best on their final credentialing exam when they do the following:

1. Get started right away,
2. Interact with the content, quizzes, and practice exams frequently,
3. Revisit the content over an extended period, and
4. View all the content.

Here's a detailed study plan and checklist to get you started! This guide is a day-to-day breakdown of how you might engage with your course. Feel free to modify it to meet your schedule and personal preference.

Week 1: Professional Development and Responsibility

Day 1	• Log into your course and access the course content. • Launch the interactive tour to learn how to navigate the content. • Read the course introduction. • Download the study guide.	
Day 2	• Read Chapter 1, Lessons 1-5. • Complete the associated knowledge check activities.	
Day 3	• Read Chapter 1, Lessons 6 and 7 • Complete the associated knowledge check activities. • Complete the Chapter 1 quiz.	
Day 4	• Read Chapter 2, Lessons 1-5. • Complete the associated knowledge check activities.	
Day 5	• Read Chapter 2, Lessons 6 and 7 • Complete the associated knowledge check activities. • Complete the Chapter 2 quiz.	
Day 6	• Complete the Section 1 Review and Practice test. • Consider the following: ○ What has been your experience with personal training thus far? What led you to want to pursue education in personal training? ○ When you have a busy week, what's going to motivate you to keep learning?	
Day 7	• Catch up on any activities as needed. • Review concepts that you felt were challenging. • Review the study guide and note any concepts you covered this week.	

Week 2: Client Relations and Behavioral Coaching

Day 1	- Read Chapter 3, Lessons 1-3. - Complete the associated knowledge check activities.	
Day 2	- Read Chapter 3, Lessons 4 and 5. - Complete the associated knowledge check activities. - Complete the Chapter 3 quiz.	
Day 3	- Read Chapter 4, Lessons 1-4. - Complete the associated knowledge check activities.	
Day 4	- Read Chapter 4, Lessons 5-6. - Complete the associated knowledge check activities.	
Day 5	- Read Chapter 4, Lesson 7. - Complete the associated knowledge check activities. - Complete the Chapter 4 quiz.	
Day 6	- Complete the Section 2 Review and Practice test. - Consider the following: - What role does psychology play in fitness training and client motivation? - What are your own barriers to regular exercise? - What helps you stay engaged with regular exercise? What exercises or movement activities do you most enjoy? Why?	
Day 7	- Catch up on any activities as needed. - Review concepts that you felt were challenging. - Review the study guide and note any concepts you covered this week.	

Week 3: The Body's Systems

Day 1	- Read Chapter 5, Lessons 1-3. - Complete the associated knowledge check activities.	
Day 2	- Read Chapter 5, Lessons 4 and 5. - Complete the associated knowledge check activities.	
Day 3	Complete the Chapter 5 quiz.	
Day 4	- Read Chapter 6, Lessons 1-3. - Complete the associated knowledge check activities.	
Day 5	- Read Chapter 6, Lessons 4 and 5. - Complete the associated knowledge check activities.	
Day 6	- Complete the Chapter 6 quiz. - Consider the following: - What did you learn this week that you hadn't known before? - What did you find the most difficult to understand? What might you do to help better understand?	
Day 7	- Catch up on any activities as needed. - Review concepts that you felt were challenging. - Review the study guide and note any concepts you covered this week.	

Week 4: Movement Science, Metabolism, and Bioenergetics

Day 1	- Read Chapter 7, Lessons 1-4. - Complete the associated knowledge check activities.	
Day 2	- Read Chapter 7, Lessons 5-7. - Complete the associated knowledge check activities.	
Day 3	Complete the Chapter 7 quiz.	
Day 4	- Read Chapter 8, Lessons 1-3 - Complete the associated knowledge check activities.	
Day 5	- Read Chapter 8, Lesson 4 and 5. - Complete the associated knowledge check activities.	
Day 6	- Complete the Chapter 8 quiz. - Consider the following: - What did you learn this week that you hadn't known before? - What did you find the most difficult to understand? What might you do to help better understand?	
Day 7	- Catch up on any activities as needed. - Review concepts that you felt were challenging. - Review the study guide and note any concepts you covered this week.	

Week 5: Nutrition and Supplementation

Day 1	- Read Chapter 9, Lessons 1-3. - Complete the associated knowledge check activities.	
Day 2	- Read Chapter 9, Lessons 4-6. - Complete the associated knowledge check activities.	
Day 3	- Read Chapter 9, Lessons 7-9. - Complete the associated knowledge check activities. - Complete the Chapter 9 quiz.	
Day 4	- Read Chapter 10, Lessons 1-3. - Complete the associated knowledge check activities.	
Day 5	- Read Chapter 10, Lesson 4 and 5. - Complete the associated knowledge check activities. - Complete the Chapter 10 quiz.	
Day 6	- Complete the Section 3 Review and Practice test. - Consider the following: - How do you approach nutrition and supplementation today? Has this week's material changed your perspective in any way? - What concepts do you feel you struggled with? How might you seek to understand those concepts further?	
Day 7	- Catch up on any activities as needed. - Review concepts that you felt were challenging. - Review the study guide and note any concepts you covered this week.	

Week 6: Assessment

Day 1	- Read Chapter 11, Lessons 1-3. - Complete the associated knowledge check activities.	
Day 2	- Read Chapter 11, Lessons 4-6. - Complete the associated knowledge check activities.	
Day 3	Complete the Chapter 11 quiz.	
Day 4	- Read Chapter 12, Lessons 1-3. - Complete the associated knowledge check activities.	
Day 5	- Read Chapter 12, Lesson 4 and 5. - Complete the associated knowledge check activities. - Complete the Chapter 12 quiz.	
Day 6	- Complete the Section 4 Review and Practice test. - Consider the following: - Have you used any training assessments before? Have you had an assessment done for you? What was your experience? - How might data from assessments help you in training or developing training plans? - What role does scope of practice play in gathering assessment data?	
Day 7	- Catch up on any activities as needed. - Review concepts that you felt were challenging. - Review the study guide and note any concepts you covered this week.	

Week 7: Integrated Training and Flexibility Training

Day 1	- Read Chapter 13, Lessons 1 and 2. - Complete the associated knowledge check activities.	
Day 2	- Read Chapter 13, Lessons 3 and 4. - Complete the associated knowledge check activities.	
Day 3	Complete the Chapter 13 quiz.	
Day 4	- Read Chapter 14, Lessons 1-4. - Complete the associated knowledge check activities.	
Day 5	- Read Chapter 14, Lessons 5-8. - Complete the associated knowledge check activities.	
Day 6	- Complete the Chapter 14 quiz. - Consider the following: - What are your initial impressions of the OPT model? - Before this week, how did you think about training? How did the content from this week change your perspective? - What about flexibility training was a new concept for you? Was there anything surprising in this week's content?	
Day 7	- Catch up on any activities as needed. - Review concepts that you felt were challenging. - Review the study guide and note any concepts you covered this week.	

Week 8: Cardiorespiratory and Core Training

Day 1	- Read Chapter 15, Lessons 1-3. - Complete the associated knowledge check activities.	
Day 2	- Read Chapter 15, Lessons 4-6. - Complete the associated knowledge check activities.	
Day 3	Complete the Chapter 15 quiz.	
Day 4	- Read Chapter 16, Lessons 1-3. - Complete the associated knowledge check activities.	
Day 5	- Read Chapter 16, Lessons 4 and 5. - Complete the associated knowledge check activities.	
Day 6	- Complete the Chapter 16 quiz. - Consider the following: - What were some misconceptions you had about cardio and core training prior to this week's content? - What are your favorite cardio and core training exercises? Why? How might understanding this help you with clients?	
Day 7	- Catch up on any activities as needed. - Review concepts that you felt were challenging. - Review the study guide and note any concepts you covered this week.	

Week 9: Balance and Plyometric Training

Day 1	- Read Chapter 17, Lessons 1-3. - Complete the associated knowledge check activities.	
Day 2	- Read Chapter 17, Lessons 4 and 5. - Complete the associated knowledge check activities.	
Day 3	Complete the Chapter 17 quiz.	
Day 4	- Read Chapter 18, Lessons 1 and 2. - Complete the associated knowledge check activities.	
Day 5	- Read Chapter 18, Lessons 3 and 4. - Complete the associated knowledge check activities.	
Day 6	- Complete the Chapter 18 quiz. - Consider the following: - What misconceptions did you have about balance and plyometric (reactive) training before this week's content? - What are your favorite balance and plyometric (reactive) training exercises? Why? How might understanding this help you with clients?	
Day 7	- Catch up on any activities as needed. - Review concepts that you felt were challenging. - Review the study guide and note any concepts you covered this week.	

Week 10: SAQ and Resistance Training

Day 1	- Read Chapter 19, Lessons 1-4. - Complete the associated knowledge check activities.	
Day 2	Complete the Chapter 19 quiz.	
Day 3	- Read Chapter 20, Lessons 1-7. - Complete the associated knowledge check activities.	
Day 4	- Read Chapter 20, Lessons 8-14. - Complete the associated knowledge check activities.	
Day 5	Complete the Chapter 20 quiz.	
Day 6	- Complete the Section 5 Review and Practice test. - Consider the following: - What were some misconceptions you had about SAQ and resistance training prior to this week's content? - What are your favorite SAQ and resistance training exercises? Why? How might understanding this help you with clients?	
Day 7	- Catch up on any activities as needed. - Review concepts that you felt were challenging. - Review the study guide and note any concepts you covered this week.	

Week 11: The OPT Model and Exercise Modalities

Day 1	- Read Chapter 21, Lessons 1-4. - Complete the associated knowledge check activities.	
Day 2	- Read Chapter 21, Lessons 5-7. - Complete the associated knowledge check activities.	
Day 3	Complete the Chapter 21 quiz.	
Day 4	- Read Chapter 22, Lessons 1-4. - Complete the associated knowledge check activities.	
Day 5	- Read Chapter 22, Lessons 5-7. - Complete the associated knowledge check activities.	
Day 6	- Complete the Chapter 22 quiz. - Consider the following: - How might the OPT model help you in training? How might you use it personally and in your sessions with clients? - What exercise modalities were you familiar with before reading this content? How did you feel about using the modality? How has your perspective changed, if at all? - How does understanding the variety of modalities help you as a personal trainer?	
Day 7	- Catch up on any activities as needed. - Review concepts that you felt were challenging. - Review the study guide and note any concepts you covered this week.	

Week 12: Chronic Health Conditions and Special Populations

Day 1	- Read Chapter 23, Lessons 1-3. - Complete the associated knowledge check activities.	
Day 2	- Read Chapter 21, Lessons 4-5. - Complete the associated knowledge check activities.	
Day 3	- Read Chapter 21, Lessons 6 and 7. - Complete the associated knowledge check activities.	
Day 4	Complete the Chapter 23 quiz.	
Day 5	Complete the Section 6 Review.	
Day 6	- Complete Section 6 practice test. - Consider the following: - Are there any health considerations or groups that you'd be most interested in working with? - How prepared do you feel to accommodate the needs of different individuals?	
Day 7	- Catch up on any activities as needed. - Review concepts that you felt were challenging. - Review the study guide and note any concepts you covered this week.	

Week 13: Certification Review and Practice

Day 1	- Catch up on any activities as needed. - Review the Conclusion and Appendices.	
Day 2	- Review final exam expectations. - Review course content and study guide.	
Day 3	Attempt the practice exam	
Day 4	Review your practice exam results for areas you need further review.	
Day 5	Schedule your exam.	
Day 6	- Catch up on any activities as needed. - Review concepts that you felt were challenging.	
Day 7	- Consider the following: - Think back to your first week. What motivated you to pursue the certified personal trainer? - What have been your experiences with learning and testing before now? What did you learn about yourself during those experiences that can help you now? - How comfortable are you with the content, and how prepared do you feel for your exam?	

Week 14: Certification Review and Practice

Day 1	Catch up on any activities as needed.	
Day 2	Review course content and study guide.	
Day 3	Repeat the practice exam	
Day 4	Review your practice exam results for areas you need further review.	
Day 5	Review your practice exam results for areas you need further review.	
Day 6	- Catch up on any activities as needed. - Repeat the practice exam as desired.	
Day 7	- Consider the following: - What are you most looking forward to at the end of this journey? - How do you plan to begin applying what you've learned?	

Week 15: Certification Exam

Week 15	- Take your certification exam. - Reflect on the work you've done these past 15 weeks and celebrate your effort! - Begin considering how you'll maintain your certification with continuing education.	
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